October 21, 2026

To Mayor Clint Morris, City Attorney Mike Drella, & City Clerk Erica Bluege

We hereby request Project Hawkeye be placed on the Committee of the Whole agenda for Monday night October 26, 2026 for discussion. Thank you in advance.

RIC BRERETON

JOHN ALBERTINI

Mike Drella

From: Rebecca Meyer <r
Sent: Monday, October 26, 2026 12:17 PM
To: Ric Brereton
Subject: Re: Document shared with you: "Questions/Concerns for 10/26/26"
Attachments: 10:26:26 constituent comments concerns .docx

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Hello Ric,

I have sent it to you via a word document rather than google doc. I bolded what I believe are the most impactful questions/concerns...if you can get us answers to any of this really or use it to your advantage to help stop this thing, is what we are all hoping comes out of sharing it with you. If I can do anything else, please let me know.

Thank you,

Becca

On Mon, Oct 26, 2026 at 9:54 AM Ric Brereton <rbrereton@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

> Good Morning Rebecca,
>
> Thank you for your email. I am able to view the document, but unable to print it or anything else. Please advise. Thank you again.
>
> Ric Brereton
> 5th Ward Alderman
> City of Belvidere
> 401 Whitney Blvd.
> Belvidere, IL 61008
> 815-544-2055
>
> ---
>
> **From:** Rebecca Meyer (via Google Docs) <r :om>
> **Sent:** Sunday, October 25, 2026 7:27 PM
> **To:** Ric Brereton
> **Subject:** Document shared with you: "Questions/Concerns for 10/26/26"

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Rebecca Meyer shared a document



Rebecca Meyer (r[illegible]) has invited you to **edit** *the following document:*

Thank you again for your efforts. You're a good human and we appreciate you!



Questions/Concerns for 10/26/26



This email grants access to this item without logging in. Only forward it to people you trust.

Open

Does this item look suspicious? Report



Google LLC, 1600 Amphitheatre Parkway, Mountain View, CA 94043, USA
You have received this email because rileyr1193@gmail.com shared a document with you from Google Docs.

-Fresh water depletion of our aquifer and resulting waste water contamination.

-Have the mayor, Drella, or any aldermen been flown out to look at data centers or to anywhere for data center relations?

-Destruction of viable black earth farmland and natural wildlife habitat.

-Loss of generational family farms and income.

-Adjacent properties completely devalued.

-Polinator bees have been named an endangered species by the federal government. A data center will disrupt bee activity and their communication system leading to their death.

-bald eagles hunt there-Indian preservation sign on fern hill road

-the billionaires will make money and the mayor and city council ignore that it will be obsolete in several years

-Who made who sign NDAs? Who signed NDAs? When did that happen?

-Were environmental studies done?

-How many are needed? It seems they are putting a data center in every town. Why? Seems like overkill.

-What are the benefits to the town?

-Can you guarantee you will be in operation in 10 years? We can't just turn the land back into farmland.

-I would assume that the land, like the water, would be too polluted to grow anything after the Data Centers are obsolete.

-Who is paying for the grid update if needed? How much will our electric go up? How many back up generators will be needed?

-How much and how long for construction traffic? Who will pay for the roads to be redone when it's done as it may ruin the roadways.

-How many permanent jobs will this center create?

-Isn't the new thing to go "electric" with cars, lawn care, bikes, ect to "save the earth from pollution" but yet we are going to build something that is horrific for the earth?

-Why do we need 2 data centers within 5 miles or less of each other?

-How many diesel generators will be on-site, how often will they run, and how will our air quality be protected?

-The chemicals used to clean and treat the water for this facility—where do they go when you're done with them, and how do we know they won't end up in our local water supply or sewers?

-Are we giving them a tax break, and after all our city expenses are paid, how much real money does the city actually make?

-What guarantees do neighbors have that this won't spread into nearby farmland or residential neighborhoods later on?

-If technology changes or this company goes out of business in 10 or 15 years, who pays to tear it down and clean up the property?

-Who will pay to drill my new well when the water runs out?

-What will all of these data centers, 2 within short distance of each other, provide and to who?

-Why are we allowing our natural habitat to be reduced to a giant windowless building?

-Are the local aquifers going to be able to handle the water consumption that it will use if it is water cooled?

- Will the city of belvidere's water and sewer be able to handle several million gallons a day and if not what will the cost be for that?

-In the FOIA documents, estimated cost to run water was 15 million, are the tax payers on the hook for this?

-Will there be a decomissioning clause so when 20 years rolls down the line and this is obsolete it will be taken care of and not just an abandoned eye sore?

-When will an environmental impact study be done?

-If we are expanding town further then our comprehensive plan, when will this be updated?

-Will there be a decommissioning bond for when this thing fails or they decide they don't need it anymore? And if they sell to another company, if the decommissioning agreement carries to the new owners?

-Does our small fire protection districts have the ability to handle that type of fire should something happen and it overheats or gets struck by lightning or something like that?

-Which 'select' Aldermen knew of this project before the others? Have a feeling they will deny it.

-How do backup generators operate? How often will they be tested?

-What air quality permits are in place? (EPA)

-What exhaust and emissions will neighbors experience?

-Where does the water come from?

-Will aquifer testing be done at any time before the project and how often after?

-How often will they test our water for contaminates?

-What are the noise levels and how will these be monitored/enforced?

-Why was this done so secretly from the public?

-What has the 150,000 "slush" fund been used for?

-If our wells run dry and/or contaminated, will they supply bottled water for all the people and animals in Spring Township and beyond?

-What happens when there are power outages for hours/days, the well pumps cannot pump so no water in the house to use the shower or toilet. Will they provide generators for every household? Simple questions for day to day life.

-WATER WATER WATER. Full transparency on water consumption and effect on local aquifer.

-Some type of study showing how this added load will increase strain on PJM power supply and how that will affect ComEd customer supply rates

-How much generation will be on site? Carbon footprint implications, etc..

-Tax breaks and or tax revenue for this property

-The ISGS data from the 2025 study indicated no immediate threat to Boone County's local drinking water supply, even though the shared aquifer with Joliet has dropped 800' for them with their data centers and ours down 100'. How are local officials helping to manage and safeguard shared water resources?

-What are specific groundwater protection recommendations for Boone County residents? After all, there will be millions of gallons of water removed daily. Belvidere taxpayers along with the state of Illinois contributed to the cost of $500,000 for the study, we should be entitled to know the results and plans to safeguard .

-It's not just the pollution of the data center itself, but the construction. How will the ongoing dust, sounds, lights from 24 hour construction be addressed - the damage to our air systems (furnace,air ducts, air conditioners), coating of dust and polluted concrete particles?

-Effects on our health? Effects on our mental well being? The entire city will be affected air and sound pollution know no boundaries.

-How will you protect our children in the schools within a mile and a half radius from all of this?

-How much money has the city of Belvidere, Boone County, the State of Illinois or anyone representing any of these three already received (excluding the property owner)?

-What financial promises have been made to the city of Belvidere, Boone County, the State of Illinois or any person representing the city, county or state.

-• Public Act 102-1123 (House Bill 4412, signed January 27, 2023) &
• Public Act 104-0458 (Effective June 1, 2026):
Both restrict local municipalities from rejecting solar or wind farms.
Are there similar restrictions regarding objections to data centers?

-Is the city growth plan map being updated?

-How many species of plants, animals and microorganisms are being destroyed because of the building, water usage, noise etc.?

-Mr. Mayor, What made you think, this approach was better than having an open, honest dialog with your constituents? (Not a facetious question, I'm genuinely interested in the thought process).

-How long before they are outdated?

-How long before they figure out how to put them up in space?

-What happens to them when they are outdated?

-Who pays for them to be torn down and hauled away?

-The mayor and council don't care- it will be obsolete in several years, our farmland will be gone, my electric bill has already gone up 50%- we are all underwater with all the rising prices- this can not happen.

-My biggest concern is impacts to wild life, noise pollution and water. Our aquifer is already low. We cannot support this!

-Does the mayor, Mike Drella or any aldermen have vacation homes or second homes and where?

-Will this site require nuclear powered energy source(s)?

-The state merely passed statutes setting forth the standards the unit of local government has to use to evaluate a battery recharge facility and a solar firm. The county board or the city council still makes the decision by applying these standards to the evidence presented. Two different

appellate courts have disagreed with each other, including our local appellate court who said that the unit of local government can use whatever standards it wants in addition to those specified by statute. On September 30th the Illinois Supreme Court voted to accept that case on a Petition For Leave To Appeal and will issue a decision next year. Nothing in either of these State statutes removes the vote by the County Board to approve either a solar farm or a battery recharge facility. The new proposed legislation by the state for data centers merely says that the unit of local government, such as the County Board, must use reasonable standards to approve and did not specify any specific standard. The county's zoning authority remains intact.

-Light pollution

-How will they handle the several degree increase in the soil temp surrounding the facility?

-How will they compensate the surrounding farms for their losses?

-Again, these are all such well founded questions. Questions that not only our community/county is asking for answers but so is every county in this Country who is facing the building of a data center has been asking . Why are our City Councils so ignorant and oblivious? Easy answer- they have been swayed with $$$$. This technology is forever rapidly evolving and changing that these centers will be quickly outdated. But... they will have accomplished their mission- they will have collected all our data and tendered us, the people, helpless. We are already experiencing rogue AI agents now getting into bank accounts and banks are scrambling to make sure they are not responsible for the losses.

-Why is the city council and mayor not working for the citizens of Belvidere? They appear to not support the public's huge concerns over the data center development.

-Why is there not more transparency? It appears the city government is handling the data center issue like it's a dictatorship. Why? This is (small town) Belvidere USA, remember? Remember all of the great things about Belvidere? For the love of God and countrymen/women don't turn your backs on it now.

-My property abuts the proposed site.
How will this effect the Honeybee hives on my property?
How will the loss of the tributary waterways effect Mosquito Creek and the downstream waterways (Coon Creek and the Kishwaukee River)

-This is Mike Novak's question: What do you have to say to the residents who currently live on the development site, whose properties will be uninhabitable from pollution, water scarcity, noise, and will be completely surrounded by an industrial compound that was built where it was never supposed to be allowed?

-Thanks Ric. Now we need it put on the agenda not just for discussion as the mayor wrote it in, but to add it to be acted upon! Put it to a vote to see if they should continue the research or stop it in its tracts. Put an ordinance in stopping such projects. And allow the agenda to have interaction with the public/city council. I put that request in. Mayor refused to put it on the agenda.

-Mayor Morris, how many times have you, alone or with anyone else, including building, planning and zoning and the village attorney, communicated in any format (example: phone - work or private, electronically or by any means) with the data center group running project hawkeye? what was discussed?

-Mayor Morris, reference the $150,000, please explain in detail what was discussed and how long was that discussion. Mr. Drella, same question for you.

-Mayor Morris have you ever met, spoken or communicated with any city official, city employee, county employee, county official about the project? When and how many times? What was discussed?

-Mayor Morris, Have you met individually with any alderman and spoke about the project? Have you met with more than one at a time, if so who, when and where, what was discussed? (I hope he says no, I know he has.)
Same for Mr Drella.

Mike Drella

From: Paul McCaffrey <[redacted]nail.com>
Sent: Monday, October 26, 2026 11:10 AM
To: Sandra Gramkowski
Subject: Re: meeting

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I have several people reading, because 5 minutes isnt enough to get through them all. Having multiple residences read show more support from the constituents that they are against the data center. Hope your doing well.

On Mon, Oct 26, 2026 at 11:03 AM Sandra Gramkowski <SGramkowski@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

Hello Paul

I believe you can read them all. If you'd like, I believe you can print off 12 copies and distribute them to the council members for us to see.

I plan on making every effort to be at the meeting tonight!

On Oct 24, 2026, at 11:58 AM, Paul McCaffrey [redacted]> wrote:

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Sandra,

Are you able to get anyone that resides in the city to read any of the attached files?

I did research and wrote these out from an AI search online. I also attached the one I will read. We have a retired teacher that will read one, However I don't know which one she will choose yet.
I will read the Request for the agenda.

Please get back to me as soon as possible, so I may coordinate these to be read at public comments.

Thank you,

Paul
<Data Center Impacts.pdf>
<Data Center Major Environmental Impacts.pdf>
<Data Center Noise Issues.pdf>
<Data Center Pollution.pdf>
<Data Centers Core problems.pdf>

<Request For Agenda.pdf>
<Whats the environmental impact of data centers..pdf>

Mike Drella

From: SGramkowski@BelviderelL.gov
Sent: Monday, October 26, 2026 11:03 AM
To: [redacted]
Subject: Re: meeting

Hello Paul

I believe you can read them all. If you'd like, I believe you can print off 12 copies and distribute them to the council members for us to see.

I plan on making every effort to be at the meeting tonight!

On Oct 24, 2026, at 11:58 AM, Paul McCaffrey <pmccaffrey226@gmail.com> wrote:

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Sandra,

Are you able to get anyone that resides in the city to read any of the attached files?

I did research and wrote these out from an AI search online. I also attached the one I will read. We have a retired teacher that will read one, However I don't know which one she will choose yet.
I will read the Request for the agenda.

Please get back to me as soon as possible, so I may coordinate these to be read at public comments.

Thank you,

Paul
<Data Center Impacts.pdf>
<Data Center Major Environmental Impacts.pdf>
<Data Center Noise Issues.pdf>
<Data Center Pollution.pdf>
<Data Centers Core problems.pdf>
<Request For Agenda.pdf>
<Whats the environmental impact of data centers..pdf>

Mike Drella

From: Paul McCaffrey <
Sent: Saturday, October 24, 2026 11:59 AM
To: Sandra Gramkowski
Subject: meeting
Attachments: Data Center Impacts.pdf; Data Center Major Environmental Impacts.pdf; Data Center Noise Issues.pdf; Data Center Pollution.pdf; Data Centers Core problems.pdf; Request For Agenda.pdf; Whats the environmental impact of data centers..pdf

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Sandra,

Are you able to get anyone that resides in the city to read any of the attached files?

I did research and wrote these out from an AI search online. I also attached the one I will read. We have a retired teacher that will read one, However I don't know which one she will choose yet.
I will read the Request for the agenda.

Please get back to me as soon as possible, so I may coordinate these to be read at public comments.

Thank you,

Paul

Data Center Impacts

The rapid growth of data centers, accelerated heavily by the boom in AI has led to significant and interconnected impacts on local communities, national infrastructure, and the environment. While they serve as the digital foundation for the modern world their physical footprint is increasingly a subject of public debate and regulatory scrutiny

1. **Power Grid & Energy Demands**:
   Data Centers are the most energy intensive facilities on earth. The international energy agency projects that their electric consumption is set to double by 2030, driving more than half the total electricity demand in the United States

   - **Rising Utility Bills**: To Support the massive energy needs of data centers, utility companies must fund costly infrastructure and power plant expansions. Studies have shown that these costs are frequently passed onto residents.
   - **Grid Reliability**: The sudden, heavy load strains existing power grids raising community concerns over localized power shortages and brownouts.
   - **Fossil Fuel Reliance**: Many center operators rely on backup diesel generators, that are tested frequently, and when needed can run constantly for days at a time. This shifts the burden to local air quality by releasing nitrogen oxides and particle matter, while further incentivizing fossil fuel production.
2. **Water Consumption**
   Keeping thousands of servers from overheating requires millions of gallons of water, creating severe local vulnerabilities, particularly because **two-thirds of data centers built since 2022 sit in water-stressed regions, or well water.**
   - **Direct Consumption (cooling):** Traditional evaporation cooling can require a single large facility to consume **1 to 5 million**

Gallons per day- equivalent to the daily usage of a town up to 50,000 people (twice the size of Belvidere).

- **Indirect Consumption (power Generation):** The water used to generate the electricity required by data centers is vastly higher than is used for on-site cooling. Across seven heavily impacted States including Virginia, Texas and California, electricity generated for data centers draws an estimated **3.4 trillion gallons** of fresh water annually.
- **Community Strain:** This massive draw acts as a "Giant straw" on local aquifers threatening public drinking water supplies, lowering neighborhood water pressure, and stoking legal battles over utility transparency.

3. **Local Community and Quality of life:** Because data centers require massive physical footprints, their physical expansion into suburban and rural areas directly alters local environments
    - **Noise Pollution:** Industrial cooling fans and massive backup diesel generators run around the clock, emitting low-frequency humming that can reach up to **100 decibels**, causing severe sleep disturbances homeowners.
    - **Land use:** Data center campuses span hundreds of acres, swallowing up valuable and irreplaceable agricultural land, and natural landscapes, while destroying wildlife.
    - **The "job paradox":** While a data center costs hundreds of millions of dollars to build it requires very few permanent employees once completed. In Illinois, to get the proposed tax credit they are only required to have 20 permanent employees, lessoning the amount of tax revenue the city will benefit from. The tax credit is set to last for 20 years. For only 20 permanent jobs?
    - **Electric waste:** the hardware cycle inside the center is brief; AI must be replaced every few years to keep up with computing demands. Pritzker has a bill that would allow data centers to avoid paying sales tax on any building AI supplies that go into a data

center. Generative AI alone is projected to create up to 5 million tons of accumulated electric waste by 2030. Only 22.3 % is documented to be recycled.

Vote NO

Data Center Major Environmental Impacts

- **Electricity Consumption & Grid Strain:** Data centers demand gigawatts of power, pushing global and US energy use to record highs and raise electricity costs for local homeowners and businesses.
- **Water depletion:** Millions of gallons of water are used for evaporative server cooling and upstream power generation, stressing local water supplies.
- **Waste Heat & Urban Warming;** Continuous cooling systems exhaust large amounts of heat into the air, raising local land surface and neighborhood temperatures.
- **Air and Noise Pollution:** on site diesel and gas backup generators emit nitrogen oxides, waste particles, and greenhouse gases, while heavy HVAC equipment produces constant noise above 85-90 decibels.
- **E-Waste and resource extraction**: Rapid hardware upgrades for AI compute create millions of tons of electronic waste along with raw material mining waste.

Data Center Noise Issues

1. **Main Sources of Noise**

- **Cooling Fans and HVAC:** Thousands of server fans, massive rooftops units, and liquid-cooling chillers run at high speeds around the clock to prevent overheating
- **Diesel Generators:** Backup power systems produce a loud roar or rumble during weekly or monthly test runs, or during a power outage
- **Vibration and airflow:** Air ducts and large exhaust systems create structural vibrations and constant tonal drone.

2. **Why Data Center Noise Upsets Cummmunities**

- **Continuous exposure:** Normal sounds like cars or speech eventually stop. Data center equipment runs non-stop, 365 days a year.
- **Low-Frequency penetration:** Low-pitched rumbles do not muffle easily behind trees or house walls.
- **Health Concerns:** Documented community complaints in places like Virginia, Michigan, and Texas note that low-level noise causes sleep stress and anxiety. As outlined by **EESI DATA CENTER RESOURCES**, local noise ordinances are built for short term parties not continuous industrial hums.

Data Center Pollution

Data centers cause pollution through carbon and air emissions from fossil fueled energy, diesel backup generators, massive water consumption, chemical discharge for cooling, persistent noise and light disturbances, and chemical waste like PFAS and electronic equipment.

According to **Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health,** fine particulate matter and air drive severe public health risks and economic risks in communities.

1. **Air Pollution & Climate Emissions**
    - **Fossil Fuel Power:** Over 55% of data center energy relies on coal, natural gas, and oil, driving massive carbon dioxide (CO2) emissions.
    - **Diesel Backup Generators:** Emergency generators emit nitrogen oxides, carbon monoxide, and fine particle matter during outages and frequent regular testing.
    - **Health Costs:** Research highlighted by VCU News shows data center emissions contribute to thousands of asthma cases and premature deaths, with public health projected to reach $20 Billion annually.
2. **Water Usage & Water Pollution:**
    - **High Consumption**: AI facilities consume 1 to 5 million gallons of water daily for evaporative cooling, equivalent to a small town.
    - **Chemical Discharges:** Cooling systems release biocides, corrosion inhibitors, and trace heavy metals

such as copper, zinc, and lead into the local water networks.

- **Salinity & Depletion: Evaporation** concentrates local mineral and salt levels, straining regional basins and agricultural water supplies

3. **Noise, Heat & Chemical Pollution**
    - **Noise Pollution:** HVAC equipment, large cooling equipment, create noise levels of 85 to 96 decibels, disrupting sleep, wildlife and farm animals.
    - **Thermal Heat Islands:** Waste heat from dense server operations can raise ambient air temperatures in suburban neighborhoods by up to 4 degrees Fahrenheit and higher in cities.
    - **PFAS & E-Waste:** Semiconductor, coolants, and fire suppressants leak "forever chemicals" (PFAS), alongside accumulating electronic waste (E-waste) from discarded hardware. Emergency responders need more equipment and highly efficient training for data centers. Usually, it's a onetime cost paid by the data center, however, the municipalities tax payers will eventually pick up the full on going coast.
    - **Unique Hazards:** Data centers present high-voltage electric systems, large scale uninterruptible power, supplies, backup lithium-ion battery arrays (with thermal runaway explosion risks), and specialized clean agent or inert gas suppression systems rather than standard commercial structures. This will create a high cost for training and risk to BFD firefighter injury.

Core Problems with Data Center Tax incentives & Grid Strain

- **Surging Consumer Utility Bills:** Rapid expansion of power-hungry data centers has driven up the regional capacity costs through the PJM interconnection, leading to residential electricity price hikes of a of 12% up to nearly 50% for ComEd and Ameren customers.
- **Cost Shifting to Ratepayers:** Critics and clean energy advocates argue that subsidized tech companies with tax breaks while ordinary households absorb the infrastructure and grid-expansion cost is unfair. The proposed tax incentive to the data centers by Pritzker allows the cost of the infrastructure to be past onto the households through a loophole item on the utility bill.
- **Supply and demand:** economics demand that through supply and demand increase rates will increase and together with the prementioned shifting electric cost, now there will be two major avenues for ComEd to raise electric bills which will have a compounding effect every time future rates are raised. Keep in mind the City of Belvidere Electric Rates will increase too. Another tax burden.

Currently Passed onto Constituency

- Right now, tech companies benefit from regular industrial utility structures, shifting their massive growth expenses onto ordinary households in two ways.

1. **The supply Side (Capacity Market Auctions):** Grid operators like PJM interconnection and MISO hold auctions to secure enough reserve power to prevent blackouts. Because data centers require massive, round-the-clock electricity, their projected demand has sent auction prices through the roof. Since reserves make up roughly 20% of the supply portion of the consumer's bill, these soaring auction costs are divided up and passed directly to residential ComEd and American customer, driving up supply charges by 29% to 50%
2. **Infrastructure upgrades:** When a 500-megawatt data center connects to the grids, the utility company must build new high-voltage transmission lines, substations, and local distribution infrastructure to handle the load. Under existing utility frameworks, the multi million dollar costs for these broad grid expansions are rolled into the utilities' overall rate bases, meaning **ALL RATEPAYERS SUBSIDIZE THE UPGRADES THROUGH DELIVERY RATE HIKES.**

(This is a multilevel tax burden. Not only will the homeowner have an increase rate, but the City of Belvidereand other taxing bodies will also pay more for the streetlights, their buildings, (City Hall, water treatment facilities, Fire Departments, Police Department, Schools, Post Office, Couty and township buildings, park district facilities, non-profit organizations, small independent family-owned businesses etc. Thus, an additional tax burden.)

Conclusion: A Data centers is not good for the citizens and business owners of Belvidere!

Request for agenda to be added to city council meeting

In summary: On October 15th ,2026 I spoke in person with the City Clerk Erica Bluege inquiring about the process of requesting an item be added to the city council agenda. I told her what it was reference to, and she informed me that the mayor would have sole discretion if it were to be added to the agenda. And then she had the city attorney join the conversation. We both advised Mr. Drella what my request would be. In short, I was requesting a question and answering session between the public, the city employees and elected officials for an honest open dialogue. He said they could not talk. I asked why. He said they were simply not allowed. As he was talking his eyes shifted up to the left, down to the left and he no longer looked me straight in the eye. (note: I've been through the FBI interviews and interrogations course and the John Reid interviews and interrogation course. Body Language is a key indicator if someone is telling the truth or alibiing, His body language was indicating he may have not being truthful). I then said other municipalities engage with the public in Illinois adding that its been on the news and on social media. He said it hasn't, they are not allowed. I told him I disagreed. I then asked him for the a regulation of the Illinois compiled statute governing that politicians are not allowed to speak with the public. He then said "I'll just give them legal advice to not reply (Or Speak).

Now I'm Going to read my email requesting the agenda that I requested be added to the agenda.

from:	**Paul McCaffrey** <p [illegible] l.com>
to:	1. cityclerk@belvidereil.gov
cc:	1. mayor@belvidereil.gov
date:	Oct 15, 2026, 10:56 PM
subject:	Meetings
mailed-by:	gmail.com

Erica Bluege and Honorable Mayor Clinton Morris,

I am writing this correspondence to you as a constituent to request an item be placed on the agenda for the Belvidere Committee of the Whole Meeting on Monday, October 26th, 2026, and the City Council Regular Meeting on Monday, November 2nd, 2026.
The item I am requesting to add is to allow the public to ask questions and receive full replies by the city official('s) they address the question to. allowing heads of departments, alderman , city attorney and the mayor to reply when addressed.

There has been too much information about a data center project that has not been corroborated, which has led to much misinformation and distrust. To remedy this the public and city could learn and benefit much from such an interaction. I have researched information on data centers and one main concern I have is that the vast majority of areas where data centers are constructed and go on line the public sees a substantial increase in their electric bills. I do hope that each alderman and city official and department head is educating themselves on data centers so they can make informed decisions on this matter.

I implore you to allow the public to have an open dialect with the city at these meetings.

Respectfully submitted,

Paul E McCaffrey
2415 Ridgefield Dr.
Belvidere, Il 61008

Erica Bluege ericabluege@belvidereil.gov Oct 16, 2026, 12:46 PM

Received. Thank you.

Erica Bluege
City Clerk
City of Belvidere
401 Whitney Boulevard
Belvidere, IL 61008
(815) 544-2612

What's the environmental impact of data centers?

Unchecked electricity demand from data centers threatens to increase health and climate-harming pollution, deplete water supplies, and undermine our transition to clean energy. Nearby communities suffer from increases in local air and water pollution, electronic waste, and noise pollution.

AI data centers also require immense amounts of water for cooling, often one to five million gallons per day. Although less water-intensive technologies are available, most data centers still rely on inefficient evaporative cooling.

Rather than clean batteries, many data centers rely on dirty diesel generators for backup power, which emit toxic air pollution including nitrogen oxides, particulate matter, and carbon monoxide. These Generators don't just operate during an outage, they are tested regularly, as often as weekly.

Current projections for the growing energy demand of data centers threaten to keep fossil fuel-burning power plants online, disrupting our transition to clean energy.

Utilities and their affiliated companies see the construction of new power plants as a lucrative opportunity for a guaranteed profit. Our health and climate should not be sacrificed for big tech companies' speculative bet on AI.

Will my electricity bill go up because of data centers?

Utilities spend billions to serve the immense energy demands of individual data centers, often leaving communities footing the bill.

The upfront costs for new power plants with grid infrastructure to serve data centers can exceed billions of dollars. Generations of customers could be on the hook to pay off those costs, unless utilities and regulators implement protections to ensure data centers pay their own way. Illinois has not done that, nor does the pending act.

Data center companies often negotiate secretive, special contracts for discounted power rates with utilities that shift costs onto regular household utility bills. Data centers are also raising wholesale electricity prices. In the biggest electricity market in the country, PJM, data centers caused wholesale costs to increase by $7.3 billion in a recent auction. They were also responsible for an additional $4.4 billion in transmission projects in 2024 alone.

Tech companies need to pay their fair share. Households should not be subsidizing electricity for some of America's largest, wealthiest companies.

How are tech companies and utilities getting away with it?

Tech companies often use non-disclosure agreements (NDAs) and confidential contracts to hide information about their contracts and rates from public view. Even local government officials are forced to sign NDAs.

The public has a right to know what these companies pay for electricity, and how much water they consume. Especially when local communities bear the burden of increased pollution and costs.

Mike Drella

From: Paul McCaffrey <p[redacted]gmail.com>
Sent: Tuesday, October 20, 2026 5:22 PM
To: jhoiness@belvidereil.gov
Subject: Fwd: Meetings

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

---------- Forwarded message ---------
From: **Paul McCaffrey** <p[redacted]
Date: Tue, Oct 20, 2026 at 5:19 PM
Subject: Fwd: Meetings
To: John Albertini <jalbertini@belvidereil.gov>, <cstevens@belvidereil.gov>, Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov>, <wfrank@belvidereil.gov>, Sandra Gramkowski <SGramkowski@belvidereil.gov>, <Mmcgee@belvidereil.gov>, <mfleury@belvidereil.gov>, Ric Brereton <rbrereton@belvidereil.gov>, <cmontalbano@belvidereil.gov>

All Aldermen of the Belvidere City Council,

Attached below is an email that I sent to the city clerk and Mayor Morris requesting an important item be added to the agenda to two future meetings. Can you please persuade the mayor to add this to the agenda? If the Mayor chooses not to add the items to the agenda it can be added by two aldermen requesting it be added. I urge you all to research data centers to make informed decisions and have a much needed open dialect with your constituents that voted you into office. I did my research and the public is allowed to ask questions to public officials in meetings if on an agenda. I also did my research on the pros and cons of data/ai centers and the cons outweigh the benefits of such centers. The property tax savings that may possibly happen t would not come close to outweighing the detriments of such a data center. The property tax savings could also be wiped out with a strike of a pen by Governor Pritzker which he has campaigned to do. Please open up a public forum at these meetings on the agenda to have an open discussion from whatever the public would like to ask. This should be an open book with its impact on the Belvidere Community.

Thank you for your sincere consideration,

Paul McCaffrey
2415 Ridgefield Dr.

---------- Forwarded message ---------
From: **Paul McCaffrey** <p[redacted].com>
Date: Thu, Oct 15, 2026 at 10:56 PM
Subject: Meetings
To: <cityclerk@belvidereil.gov>
Cc: <mayor@belvidereil.gov>

Erica Bluege and Honorable Mayor Clinton Morris,

I am writing this correspondence to you as a constituent to request an item be placed on the agenda for the Belvidere Committee of the Whole Meeting on Monday, October 26th, 2026, and the City Council Regular Meeting on Monday, November 2nd, 2026.
The item I am requesting to add is to allow the public to ask questions and receive full replies by the city official('s) they address the question to. allowing heads of departments, alderman , city attorney and the mayor to reply when addressed.

There has been too much information about a data center project that has not been corroborated, which has led to much misinformation and distrust. To remedy this the public and city could learn and benefit much from such an interaction. I have researched information on data centers and one main concern I have is that the vast majority of areas where data centers are constructed and go on line the public sees a substantial increase in their electric bills. I do hope that each alderman and city official and department head is educating themselves on data centers so they can make informed decisions on this matter.

I implore you to allow the public to have an open dialect with the city at these meetings.

Respectfully submitted,

Paul E McCaffrey
2415 Ridgefield Dr.
Belvidere, Il 61008

Mike Drella

From: Paul McCaffrey <[redacted]>
Sent: Tuesday, October 20, 2026 5:19 PM
To: John Albertini; cstevens@belvidereil.gov; Rory Peterson; wfrank@belvidereil.gov; Sandra Gramkowski; Mmcgee@belvidereil.gov; mfleury@belvidereil.gov; Ric Brereton; cmontalbano@belvidereil.gov
Subject: Fwd: Meetings

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

All Aldermen of the Belvidere City Council,

Attached below is an email that I sent to the city clerk and Mayor Morris requesting an important item be added to the agenda to two future meetings. Can you please persuade the mayor to add this to the agenda? If the Mayor chooses not to add the items to the agenda it can be added by two aldermen requesting it be added. I urge you all to research data centers to make informed decisions and have a much needed open dialect with your constituents that voted you into office. I did my research and the public is allowed to ask questions to public officials in meetings if on an agenda. I also did my research on the pros and cons of data/ai centers and the cons outweigh the benefits of such centers. The property tax savings that may possibly happen t would not come close to outweighing the detriments of such a data center. The property tax savings could also be wiped out with a strike of a pen by Governor Pritzker which he has campaigned to do. Please open up a public forum at these meetings on the agenda to have an open discussion from whatever the public would like to ask. This should be an open book with its impact on the Belvidere Community.

Thank you for your sincere consideration,

Paul McCaffrey
2415 Ridgefield Dr.

---------- Forwarded message ---------
From: **Paul McCaffrey** <[redacted]com>
Date: Thu, Oct 15, 2026 at 10:56 PM
Subject: Meetings
To: <cityclerk@belvidereil.gov>
Cc: <mayor@belvidereil.gov>

Erica Bluege and Honorable Mayor Clinton Morris,

I am writing this correspondence to you as a constituent to request an item be placed on the agenda for the Belvidere Committee of the Whole Meeting on Monday, October 26th, 2026, and the City Council Regular Meeting on Monday, November 2nd, 2026.
The item I am requesting to add is to allow the public to ask questions and receive full replies by the city official('s) they address the question to. allowing heads of departments, alderman , city attorney and the mayor to reply when addressed.

There has been too much information about a data center project that has not been corroborated, which has led to much misinformation and distrust. To remedy this the public and city could learn and benefit much from such an interaction. I have researched information on data centers and one main concern I have is that the vast majority of areas where data centers are constructed and go on line the public sees a substantial increase in their electric bills. I do hope that each alderman and city official and department head is educating themselves on data centers so they can make informed decisions on this matter.

I implore you to allow the public to have an open dialect with the city at these meetings.

Respectfully submitted,

Paul E McCaffrey
2415 Ridgefield Dr.
Belvidere, Il 61008

Mike Drella

From: Paul McCaffrey <[redacted]>
Sent: Tuesday, October 20, 2026 5:15 PM
To: John Albertini; cstevens@belvidereil.gov; Rory Peterson; wfrank@belvidereil.gov; Sandra Gramkowski; Mmcgee@belvidereil.gov; mfleury@belvidereil.gov; Ric Brereton; cmontalban@belvideril.gov
Subject: Fwd: Meetings

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

All Aldermen of the Belvidere City Council,

Attached below is an email that I sent to the city clerk and Mayor Morris requesting an important item be added to the agenda to two future meetings. Can you please persuade the mayor to add this to the agenda? If the Mayor chooses not to add the items to the agenda it can be added by two aldermen requesting it be added. I urge you all to research data centers to make informed decisions and have a much needed open dialect with your constituents that voted you into office. I did my research and the public is allowed to ask questions to public officials in meetings if on an agenda. I also did my research on the pros and cons of data/ai centers and the cons outweigh the benefits of such centers. The property tax savings that may possibly happen t would not come close to outweighing the detriments of such a data center. The property tax savings could also be wiped out with a strike of a pen by Governor Pritzker which he has campaigned to do. Please open up a public forum at these meetings on the agenda to have an open discussion from whatever the public would like to ask. This should be an open book with its impact on the Belvidere Community.

Thank you for your sincere consideration,

Paul McCaffrey
2415 Ridgefield Dr.

---------- Forwarded message ---------
From: **Paul McCaffrey** <[redacted]>
Date: Thu, Oct 15, 2026 at 10:56 PM
Subject: Meetings
To: <cityclerk@belvidereil.gov>
Cc: <mayor@belvidereil.gov>

Erica Bluege and Honorable Mayor Clinton Morris,

I am writing this correspondence to you as a constituent to request an item be placed on the agenda for the Belvidere Committee of the Whole Meeting on Monday, October 26th, 2026, and the City Council Regular Meeting on Monday, November 2nd, 2026.

The item I am requesting to add is to allow the public to ask questions and receive full replies by the city official('s) they address the question to. allowing heads of departments, alderman , city attorney and the mayor to reply when addressed.

There has been too much information about a data center project that has not been corroborated, which has led to much misinformation and distrust. To remedy this the public and city could learn and benefit much from such an interaction. I have researched information on data centers and one main concern I have is that the vast majority of areas where data centers are constructed and go on line the public sees a substantial increase in their electric bills. I do hope that each alderman and city official and department head is educating themselves on data centers so they can make informed decisions on this matter.

I implore you to allow the public to have an open dialect with the city at these meetings.

Respectfully submitted,

Paul E McCaffrey
2415 Ridgefield Dr.
Belvidere, Il 61008

Mike Drella

From: mayor@BelvidereIL.gov
Sent: Thursday, October 1, 2026 6:25 PM
To:
Subject: RE: Data Center Sanity

Good afternoon Terry,
Thank you for taking the time to send your e-mail and the attached information. I certainly appreciate your thoughts, sentiment and civility.
I apologize for the late response as I had a knuckle replacement surgery and typing has not been easy the past few weeks.

Thanks again with kind regards,
Clint
Clinton Morris
Mayor, City of Belvidere
815-544-2612 (o)

From: Terry shook <
Sent: Tuesday, September 8, 2026 4:56 PM
To: Clint Morris <mayor@BelvidereIL.gov>
Subject: Data Center Sanity

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Your Honor:
I just wanted to congratulate you on your approach to the powder keg subject of data centers. It's evident that you're using a methodical, fiduciary approach to investigating the subject, and you have Belvidere taxpayers' interests as a priority. It's also obvious that too many concerned citizens are taking an emotional approach with less than validated information. I have no doubt that at least a portion of their argument may be based on reliable information but instead of approaching it with facts it appears your detractors would rather tear you down than have their position stand on its own merits. It's unfortunate that we can't disagree without being disagreeable. That we can't hold strong convictions without questioning someone else's character. That we can't stand firmly for what we believe while still treating others with kindness, dignity, and respect.

I encourage you to do the opposite through this process. We can't control the anger and division around us, but we can control how we respond. I hope you can withstand the personal criticisms and attacks and respond with respect and encouragement - which is easier said than done. I'm not sure I personally could do it. But I have confidence that with your experience you'll approach this highly emotional subject with respect and facts. I wish you luck.

I'm attaching a timely document (you may have already seen this). Today on LinkedIn Mark Cuban wrote a post about data centers. He decided to search all of his AI resources and came up with a community guide to data centers. I hope you're able to glean some useful information from it.

In closing, I just want to offer my gratitude to your approach on researching whether a data center is in the best interest of our community. You have my support.

Terry Shook, RHU, CEBS
Primum Risk Strategies, Inc.
terry@primumriskstrategies.com
tashook@hotmail.com
(815) 742-2066
Primum
Risk Strategies, Inc.
Primumriskstrategies.com

Mike Drella

From: Office - Growth Dimensions <office@growthdimensions.org>
Sent: Tuesday, September 29, 2026 9:24 AM
To: John Wolf; Kimberly Haley; nerickson@illinoisrealtors.org; Pam Fettes; Paul Nolley; sosnowskioutreach@ilhousegop.org; Tom Walberg
Subject: Legislative Committee Agenda
Attachments: Legislative Committee Agenda and Minutes.pdf

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Good Morning All,

I am excited to see you all for our upcoming committee meeting on October 1st at 9:00 am. Attached is our agenda, minutes to approve, and additional meeting materials.

Growth Dimensions is inviting you to a scheduled Zoom meeting.
Join Zoom Meeting
https://us02web.zoom.us/j/87699846412?pwd=2m8x3Zdki0QH7xqD85bg5iGiL0d6Cy.1

View meeting insights with Zoom AI Companion
https://us02web.zoom.us/launch/edl?muid=6097f0df-423e-444a-8526-e225e31f4b64

Meeting ID: 876 9984 6412
Passcode: 250628

One tap mobile
+13092053325,,87699846412#,,,,*250628# US
+13126266799,,87699846412#,,,,*250628# US (Chicago)

Join instructions
https://us02web.zoom.us/meetings/87699846412/invitations?signature=A2Dnbl4RafrWGTS2CqWRNpca6CmfPOvxL7iqVKQ8K78

Have a great Tuesday,

Greta Skinner
Office Administrator
982 Belvidere Road, Belvidere, IL 61008
☎(815)547-4252 |
✉office@growthdimensions.org | 💻www.growthdimensions.org

GROWTH DIMENSIONS
ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT
BELVIDERE & BOONE COUNTY, IL
982 Belvidere Road | Belvidere, IL 61008

EXCELLENCE IN ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AWARDS
2025 SILVER WINNER
INTERNATIONAL ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT COUNCIL

GROWTH DIMENSIONS
ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT
BELVIDERE & BOONE COUNTY, IL

Legislative Committee Agenda
October 1st, 2026
9:00AM-10:00 AM
Join Zoom Meeting

https://us02web.zoom.us/j/87699846412?pwd=2m8x3Zdki0QH7xqD85bg5iGiL0d6Cy.1

Zoom Local Dial-In Number
1-312-626-6799
Meeting ID: 876 9984 6412
Password: 250628

I.	**Call to Order** **Approval of April 2, 2026, Legislative Committee Minutes*	John Wolf Committee
II.	**Legislative Priorities**	Committee
III.	**Legislative Update** U.S. – Canada Tariffs Data Centers Opportunity Zone 2.0 Aim Tax Credit STAR Bonds HB 5470 / Public Act 104- 0799	Committee
IV.	**Adjournment**	

Next Legislative Meeting: November 5, 2026
Next Board of Directors Meeting: November 18, 2026

Statement of Confidentiality

Meetings and discussions among members of the Growth Dimensions Executive Committee and Board of Directors will reveal information that is considered confidential or privileged. To better facilitate full and frank discussions among Committee members, and in order not to jeopardize strategic initiatives by the Committee, members have an obligation to Growth Dimensions and their fellow Committee members to protect information discussed within the Committee structure.

GROWTH DIMENSIONS
ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT
BELVIDERE & BOONE COUNTY IL

Legislative Committee Minutes
April 2, 2026
9:00 AM
Meeting ID: 891 4658 4344
Meeting Password: 228056
Join Zoom Meeting
https://us02web.zoom.us/j/89146584344?pwd=QUcvbHQ2eE9OQmlSVWZPTklyV3NCUT09

Members Present: Paul Nolley, Neeley Erickson, John Wolf, Tom Walberg,

Staff Present: Pamela Lopez-Fettes, Tabitha Villarreal, Kimberly Haley

Members Absent: Sarah Chevrier

I. The meeting was called to order by Chairman, Paul Nolley at 9:01 AM

Motion to approve Legislative Committee Minutes for November 6, 2025, Motion approved unanimously.

II. Legislative Priorities:

Motion to approve the policy statement as presented by John Wolf, second by Tom Walberg. Motion approved unanimously.

III. Legislative Update:

The committee reviewed several proposed state legislative initiatives, with a focus on housing expansion efforts aimed at reducing regulatory barriers and increasing supply. Discussion highlighted both the need for workforce housing and concerns regarding reduced local control, particularly around zoning and parking requirements.

Key housing topics included ADUs, single-staircase buildings, parking requirement reforms, and impact fee transparency. Members requested a balanced summary of these proposals, including pros and cons, aligned with Growth Dimensions' policy priorities.

Additional items discussed:

- Workplace safety standards (temperature conditions)
- Non-compete agreement limitations
- Changes to unemployment insurance processes
- Workforce reporting requirements for large employers
- Community colleges offering bachelor's degrees to improve access and address workforce need

IV. Adjournment
Motion to adjourn by John Wolf and second by Tom Walberg. Motion approved unanimously.

Growth Dimensions Economic Development
Legislative & Policy Update

Boone County, Illinois | April 2026 – September 2026

Priority Updates for Committee Review

1. Data Center Incentive Program — New Applications Halted
Status: High relevance

On June 5, 2026, the Governor directed DCEO to stop processing new applications for the Illinois Data Center Investment Program effective July 1, 2026. The program had offered qualifying data centers state/local tax exemptions and, for projects in underserved areas, a construction employment tax credit.

Sources: DCEO — Data Center Investment Tax Exemptions and Credits

2. SB 4203 — Data Center Community Benefit Agreements
Status: Monitor

Filed May 13, 2026. The bill would condition a data-center certificate of exemption on a community benefit agreement with the host community. The proposed agreement would require annual minimum payments of at least 10% of the property tax that otherwise would have been levied, with at least half of those amounts used to offset residential tax

Sources: Illinois General Assembly — SB 4203 Status

3. SB 3761 — Data Centers, Electric Infrastructure & Water
Status: Monitor

This pending proposal includes data-center disclosures to the Illinois Commerce Commission, annual water-use reporting beginning in 2027, utility tariff provisions, and a data-center clean-energy/self-direct framework. It was re-referred to Senate Assignments on May 22, 2026.

Sources: Illinois General Assembly — SB 3761 Status

4. Illinois Opportunity Zones 2.0
Status: High relevance

Illinois launched Opportunity Zones 2.0 on August 25, 2026 as part of the process for selecting the next federally designated Opportunity Zones beginning in 2027. The updated framework emphasizes economic need, investment potential, local input, regional balance, and coordination with other economic-development tools. Rural Opportunity Zones can receive enhanced federal tax treatment.

Sources: Governor of Illinois — Opportunity Zones 2.0 Announcement | DCEO — Illinois Opportunity Zones | DCEO — Opportunity Zones 2.0 FAQ (PDF)

5. Advancing Innovative Manufacturing (AIM) Tax Credit
Status: High relevance

AIM is a new Illinois tax incentive for qualifying advanced-manufacturing projects. For taxable years beginning on or after January 1, 2026, qualifying applicants generally must invest at least $10 million in eligible Illinois capital

improvements. DCEO lists credit tiers of 3%, 5%, or 7% depending on qualified investment. Eligible sectors include automotive manufacturing goods, machinery, fabricated metals, energy, life sciences, robotics, aerospace, and other advanced materials.

Sources: DCEO — Advancing Innovative Manufacturing (AIM)

6. STAR Bonds — 2026/2027 Implementation Deadlines

Status: Review local status

STAR Bonds allow eligible local governments to finance qualifying destination-oriented economic-development projects using future sales-tax increments. DCEO lists a June 1, 2026 deadline for notices of intent, January 1, 2027 for district plan proposals, and June 1, 2028 for proposed project plans.

Sources: DCEO — STAR Bonds

7. HB 5470 / Public Act 104-0799 — Economic Development Tax Credits

Status: Enacted

Signed August 7, 2026 as Public Act 104-0799. Among other DCEO-related changes, the law extends the sunset dates for the apprenticeship education expense tax credit, research and development tax credit, angel investment tax credit, and River Edge Redevelopment Zone tax credit.

Sources: Illinois General Assembly — HB 5470 / Public Act 104-0799

Source Notes

Sources were checked against official Illinois government and Illinois General Assembly pages on September 22, 2026. Bill status can change; committee materials should be refreshed before each meeting.

Primary source portals: Illinois General Assembly | Illinois DCEO

Mike Drella

From: City of Belvidere <forms@petrydesign.com>
Sent: Saturday, September 12, 2026 7:31 PM
To: mayor@belvidereil.gov
Subject: City of Belvidere Website Contact Form Submission

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Hello,

A new contact form submission was completed on the City of Belvidere website. The submission details are as follows:

Name: Mike Winters
Email: m
Phone: 8
Subject: the data center is a AI center
Comments: I watch you on the city council meeting about the data center

---

Date: September 12, 2026
Time: 7:30 pm
Page URL: https://www.belvidereil.gov/contact-the-mayor/
Remote IP: 73.176.210.205

Mike Drella

From: [redacted]m>
Sent: Tuesday, September 8, 2026 4:56 PM
To: mayor@belvidereil.gov
Subject: Data Center Sanity
Attachments: Mark Cuban A Community Guide to Data Centers.pdf

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Your Honor:
I just wanted to congratulate you on your approach to the powder keg subject of data centers. It's evident that you're using a methodical, fiduciary approach to investigating the subject, and you have Belvidere taxpayers' interests as a priority. It's also obvious that too many concerned citizens are taking an emotional approach with less than validated information. I have no doubt that at least a portion of their argument may be based on reliable information but instead of approaching it with facts it appears your detractors would rather tear you down than have their position stand on its own merits. It's unfortunate that we can't disagree without being disagreeable. That we can't hold strong convictions without questioning someone else's character. That we can't stand firmly for what we believe while still treating others with kindness, dignity, and respect.

I encourage you to do the opposite through this process. We can't control the anger and division around us, but we can control how we respond. I hope you can withstand the personal criticisms and attacks and respond with respect and encouragement - which is easier said than done. I'm not sure I personally could do it. But I have confidence that with your experience you'll approach this highly emotional subject with respect and facts. I wish you luck.

I'm attaching a timely document (you may have already seen this). Today on LinkedIn Mark Cuban wrote a post about data centers. He decided to search all of his AI resources and came up with a community guide to data centers. I hope you're able to glean some useful information from it.

In closing, I just want to offer my gratitude to your approach on researching whether a data center is in the best interest of our community. You have my support.

Terry Shook, RHU, CEBS
Primum Risk Strategies, Inc.
terry@primumriskstrategies.com
t:
(815) 742-2066
Primum
Risk Strategies, Inc.
Primumriskstrategies.com

A town's first data center: what to require before saying yes

A data center can bring construction employment, tax base, and infrastructure investment. It can also impose demands on electricity, water, public services, and nearby neighborhoods that last for decades and outlive the equipment inside.

Two facts should frame everything. The industry produces very few permanent jobs relative to its cost — one watchdog analysis of eleven major projects found subsidies averaging about $1.95 million per job. And in a survey of data center owners, only three percent named tax credits and local incentives as the biggest siting factor; land and power availability drive the decision. You are usually not paying for something that would otherwise not happen.

The basic rule: every important promise needs a stated limit, a reliable way to check it, a responsible party with money behind it, and a practical response when it is broken.

No agreement prevents disputes from reaching court. The goal is to resolve routine problems in days and to have money and legal authority already in place for the serious ones.

1. Give the town its own qualified team, paid for by the applicant

Before making any commitment, retain a land use and utility lawyer, plus independent engineering, acoustical, hydrological, and financial advisers as needed.

Where state law allows, require the developer to fund reasonable review costs through an escrow the town controls. The town selects the advisers, directs their work, and receives their conclusions. The developer funds the review and has no say in its findings. This is routine for pipelines and mines and nearly absent from data center practice.

Assign one official to coordinate, with a named backup. Keep a public calendar of notices, hearings, and deadlines.

Verify statutory notice in writing before every action that requires it. In one Virginia county, the largest data center rezoning in the country was voided by a court for defective notice after roughly twenty-seven hours of hearings; the county spent more than $1.7 million defending it and then withdrew. Notice failures destroy more deals than opposition does.

Identify the landowner, the developer, the intended operator, and the proposed financial guarantor. If the tenant is unknown, that is an unresolved condition, not a detail to be filled in later.

2. Decide whether the site works before you discuss benefits

Study the complete build-out — future phases, cooling equipment, generators, substations, transmission connections, water infrastructure — not the first building.

Ask: How close are homes, schools, and hospitals? Can the electric and water systems carry this project alongside growth already approved? What happens to roads, drainage, emergency services, farmland, and historic resources? What other uses of this land and this interconnection capacity does the town give up?

Include other committed projects drawing on the same resources.

Separation distance is worth more than any mitigation requirement. The chief economic development officer of the country's largest data center county has acknowledged publicly that officials would do it differently, and that facilities were zoned too close to homes. Where a well-resourced operator has installed acoustic mitigation in response to complaints, litigation over the same noise has continued anyway. Distance prevents the problem. Mitigation manages it, sometimes.

A community payment cannot cure an unacceptable physical impact. If the site is wrong, no number fixes it.

3. Put each protection in the document that can actually carry it

Document	Purpose
Zoning and overlay standards	Suitable locations, setbacks, height, buffers, general performance standards
Site approval or conditional use permit	Project-specific limits and conditions
Development or community agreement	Authorized payments, responsibilities, contractual remedies
Financial security instruments	Cash, escrow, or letters of credit for defined defaults and closure
Utility agreements and regulatory filings	Service, infrastructure cost allocation, reliability, customer exposure
Monitoring plan	Equipment, methods, locations, reporting, verification

There is a legal reason for the split. Demands for money or property as the price of a permit are treated as exactions and must bear an essential nexus and rough proportionality to the project's impacts — and the Supreme Court has held that putting the demand in a legislative act rather than an administrative condition does not by itself change that analysis. Ordinary regulation of how land is used — setbacks, decibel limits, use restrictions — is not analyzed that way.

So: performance standards belong in the ordinance. Money belongs in an agreement the applicant signs voluntarily, supported by consideration, and drafted with counsel who can confirm the town has authority to charge it at all. Naming a payment a "capacity fee" does not create the power to impose one.

Record enforceable land obligations, address transfers, and obtain lender subordination in writing. Recording alone does not guarantee every obligation survives foreclosure or binds a future tenant.

Do not promise to control electric service that a state commission regulates.

4. Set water limits from a defensible supply study

Have the water provider determine what it can reliably supply during drought and equipment outages, after existing commitments, environmental requirements, twenty years of expected growth, and an adequate reserve.

Then set project-specific limits on annual volume, peak-day demand, and peak-hour demand. An annual cap alone is useless — a facility can sit under it and still spike on the hottest day, which is when the system is least able to absorb it.

Account separately for water consumed and water returned. Only consumption depletes the source.

Do not accept "closed-loop" as a water commitment. Closed-circuit systems can still reject heat evaporatively, and adiabatic assist consumes water on hot days precisely when supply is tight. Regulate the heat-rejection method and the metered consumptive number, not the label.

Require a drought operating plan before approval, using the provider's actual declared stages, stating when industrial cooling demand must decline, by how much, and how domestic and fire-protection service stays whole. Restriction of cooling load should precede restriction of households, and that sequence should be written down.

Require separate metering of major uses including cooling, independent verification of the water balance, published usage reports, and retained raw data for audit.

An excess-use charge is a price signal, not permission. Paying it must not create a right to exceed a hard limit, and during declared drought the response is curtailment rather than a fee. Money does not create water.

Any required retrofit should be selected on engineering evidence, not on the assumption that one cooling technology always solves it.

5. Protect neighbors from noise before the equipment is ordered

Noise is now the most common post-approval complaint and the most active area of litigation, including proposed class actions in Wisconsin and Mississippi alleging sound carrying more than a mile past the property line and, in one case, a proposed class exceeding ten thousand people.

The reason ordinary noise rules fail here is technical. A-weighting, used in nearly every local ordinance, discounts 63 Hz by 26.2 dB and 31.5 Hz by 39.4 dB. Those are exactly the frequencies chillers and fan walls produce, and exactly the frequencies that pass through walls into bedrooms. A facility can pass a 55 dBA limit comfortably and still be unlivable next door. Content below 20 Hz may not register on standard equipment at all.

Have an independent acoustical engineer establish existing conditions over a continuous baseline period — not a spot check — and model the full campus under demanding operating conditions.

The standards should address overall level, nighttime conditions specifically, low-frequency content and audible tones, combined output from all equipment, and generator testing separately from genuine emergencies. As starting points for the engineer to validate: a background-plus-5-dB standard measured in one-third-octave bands rather than a single broadband number; a low-frequency screen based on the difference between C-weighted and A-weighted readings; and a tonality penalty for prominent tones. These are drafting positions, not settled thresholds, and they need professional review before adoption.

Specify measurement locations, weather conditions, instrument class, calibration intervals, and how unrelated sound such as traffic is excluded.

Continuous monitoring is appropriate near sensitive receivers and is not expensive relative to project cost; let the engineer set station count and locations and obtain real estimates rather than adopting a number from a template.

A monitoring alert should trigger prompt verification and a required response. It should not convert automatically into a large charge based on an unreviewed sensor reading — both because the reading may be wrong and because a charge engineered to punish rather than to compensate is likely unenforceable as a contract term.

Require commissioning tests before full operation. For persistent violations, require an engineered corrective plan on a deadline and, where authorized, restrictions on the specific equipment or activity causing the problem. Operating restrictions are a legitimate tool because noise output tracks cooling load, but tie any reduction to measured compliance rather than assuming a fixed percentage cut delivers a fixed decibel result.

6. Address on-site generation explicitly, or the rest fails

This is the loophole that has done the most damage in practice.

One state enacted a law requiring large data centers to pay for the electrical infrastructure serving them and barring utilities from shifting those costs to other customers — and the same law permitted self-generation. The result at one campus was dozens of gas turbines running more than 500 megawatts of self-supplied load, in a community already carrying elevated health burdens, with the turbines unpermitted and litigation following.

Closing the rate loophole without closing the generation loophole converts a utility bill problem into an air quality problem with no permit attached.

Distinguish emergency backup from routine generation. Cap annual run-hours. Require the applicable air permits before the certificate of occupancy, not after. Set emissions standards for the units themselves. Prohibit generation serving primary load, and account for emissions, noise, fuel storage, and testing schedules.

Any demand-reduction commitment must specify the mechanism: computing stops, batteries discharge, or generators start. Those are three different outcomes for the neighborhood.

7. Protect electricity customers and the town budget as separate questions

Require the utility and the regulator to answer three things that do not answer each other:

Who pays for infrastructure built to serve this project. Who pays if the project cancels, ramps slowly, or closes. How the project affects other customers' prices and reliability.

Be careful how you argue this publicly. The evidence is genuinely mixed — capacity market costs in one large regional market rose by billions with attributable bill impacts, while a study for the largest data center market in the world found no historical cost shift onto residential customers, and federal researchers attribute rising rates to equipment costs and an aging grid as well.

The defensible position is risk allocation, not proven harm. You are not claiming your bills already rose. You are declining to carry the risk of a stranded asset built on a forecast. That argument cannot be rebutted by a study, and it gets you the same protections.

Ask for credible demand commitments and appropriate security before project-specific infrastructure spending begins, minimum-bill and exit-fee terms with collateral, and construction and interconnection dates matched to actual grid readiness. Note that many states have already adopted large-load tariffs doing exactly this. Intervene in that docket rather than trying to replicate it locally.

8. Negotiate a public return you can defend in writing

Publish an analysis of expected taxes and contractual payments, net of incentives and public costs, stress-tested for slow construction, declining equipment values, successful tax appeals, and early closure.

Keep four categories separate and never count a dollar twice: ordinary taxes; reimbursement of project-caused costs; financial security for future obligations; and additional negotiated benefits.

On incentives, the evidence is one-sided. Several states that measured returns found they lose between 52 and 70 cents per dollar spent on data center sales tax exemptions. Four states are each losing more than a billion dollars a year. Two of the seven signed agreements in the benchmark gave no local incentive at all, and both projects proceeded. If political reality requires something, cap it at a stated cost per job, sunset it, and disclose the forgone revenue annually.

Protect the assessed value. When a facility empties, the owner appeals the assessment toward zero while the school district is still servicing bonds issued against the promised base. A negotiated valuation floor with a waiver of appeal below it is enforceable and almost never requested.

A fixed annual payment adjusted for defined capacity and inflation is easier to administer and harder to manipulate than a share of reported profit — profit can be zero on paper for a decade, and a facility built for the owner's own use may generate no local revenue at all. But confirm the town's authority to impose it before designing around it.

Report construction employment separately from permanent employment. Construction is where the jobs actually are — a thousand or more workers for two to three years. Negotiate prevailing wage, apprenticeship utilization, first-source referral, and certified payroll there. Be cautious with local-hire percentage mandates on private employment; they invite challenge, and a town that took no incentives has given up the usual defense. A training fund the community directs, with spending controls and measurable outcomes, is more durable than a headcount promise.

9. Put financial protection in place before the exposure exists

Construction damage requires security before construction. Cancellation exposure requires security before infrastructure spending. Operating and closure obligations require security before operation.

None of the seven signed agreements reviewed for this guide contained decommissioning security. Not one. That is roughly 3,600 acres and 18 million square feet with no funded path to removal.

An independent estimate should set the amount, including contingency, and be updated as scope and costs change. Prefer cash escrow or a clean standby letter of credit over a surety bond, because sureties contest claims.

For letters of credit, the mechanics decide whether you ever see the money. Banks examine the documents you present; they do not adjudicate whether the operator breached. So specify acceptable issuing banks, the exact draw certificate and its signatory, a notice-of-nonrenewal period long enough to act, and replacement security before expiration. Assign a named official and a backup to the renewal date with independent calendar reminders. The common failure is not a refused draw. It is a quiet nonrenewal nobody noticed for eight months.

Require replenishment after any draw. Preserve other lawful remedies expressly, while preventing double recovery for the same loss. One reviewed agreement made drawing the letter of credit the city's sole remedy, which turned a $20 million protection into a $20 million ceiling on a project costing roughly $10 billion.

Identify who pays if the project company cannot. A well-known tenant's name on a press release is not a guarantee. Name the guarantor, verify its financial condition, and require it to sign.

10. Approve in stages, and write the closure terms first

Define what each phase may build and operate. Condition later phases on demonstrated compliance and confirmed infrastructure capacity. Do not rely on future discretionary approvals if you have already granted the entitlement — a vested right you gave away is not leverage you still hold.

Then write the ending. The computing equipment inside these buildings is obsolete in roughly four to six years. The shell lasts thirty. Every agreement in the benchmark was written for a facility that underperforms; none was written for one that empties out.

Require a closure plan covering equipment removal, hazardous materials, site stabilization, and unpaid public obligations, with an objective trigger — sustained load below a defined threshold for a defined period is measurable from the utility meter and is not a matter of opinion. Fund it in advance.

If the town owns land, a ground lease is worth considering, because reversion is stronger than any bond. But reversion delivers a building and its liabilities. It is useful only with due diligence, access rights, environmental protections, and funded closure obligations attached.

Before the final vote, the town should be able to tell residents in plain language: what will be built, what it will consume, what the public receives, what happens if it fails, who enforces the agreement, and who pays to take it down.

If any of those answers is incomplete, resolve it before granting the approval that spends the last of the town's leverage.

Want this as a PDF in the Proposal folder alongside the others?

Mike Drella

From: rpeterson@belvidereil.gov
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 6:52 PM
To: rorybpeterson@comcast.net
Subject: Fw: Data center

From: [redacted]
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:52 PM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

> This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I agree with you.

What say you people

People really need to educate themselves on how this stuff works before they start talking about things they're afraid of, and have little to no knowledge of, like they're the experts.

That's why we keep losing things that only upset a handful of uneducated people.

The biggest one being the water conspiracy.

This is a false narrative that is entirely all too often spread, the cooling systems use closed loops that very rarely need replenished.

It is not like manufacturing facilities where they use water in the manufacturing process and then dump it into the river... Even when the Byron cooling towers dump water into the river it has to be cleaner than when they got it.

Not to mention you can't run dirty water through computer systems they will short, clog, and in general fail from the buildup of the impurities... You couldn't just run River water through a radiator guys especially not long term. It really doesn't take that much common sense to figure that out.

No, data centers do not produce runoff waste the same way that normal factories do. Also you live in the middle of a industrial city, factories are a normal thing.

Major Boost to Local Tax Revenue (Biggest Direct Win for Residents)
- The project is expected to generate a **record-level ~$60 million annually in property taxes— more than any single site has ever contributed.

- This money is earmarked for core services: **schools, parks, libraries, community college, police, fire, and general infrastructure**.
- Result for you: Potentially lower or stabilized property tax rates (less burden on homeowners), better-funded public services, and more money for local improvements without new taxes. Officials explicitly noted it could mean "less burden on property owners and more money for schools and parks."

Job Creation and Local Economic Stimulus
1,000+ temporary construction jobs over several years of building — good-paying work for local trades (electricians, laborers, technicians, etc.). Many residents or their family/friends could benefit directly or through subcontractors.
200+ permanent high-tech/operations jobs once running (technicians, security, facility managers, IT roles) — typically above-average wages.
- Broader ripple effect: Workers spend money locally (restaurants, retail, housing, services), creating indirect jobs and supporting small businesses in Belvidere and nearby areas. This is described as the largest private investment in the region's history and a step toward attracting more innovative, long-term businesses.
Infrastructure Upgrades That Benefit Nearby Homes
- A project of this scale requires reliable power, roads, utilities, and possibly broadband enhancements. The developer (an energy-focused company) and local partners will invest in or trigger these upgrades.
- For someone a mile away: You could see improved roads/access near the airport area, more stable power delivery (data centers often partner on grid reinforcements), and upgraded utilities that serve the whole surrounding neighborhood — without the full cost falling on taxpayers.
- The site already has some supporting infrastructure (previously eyed for a waste-to-energy project tied to nearby landfills), so upgrades build on existing assets.
Potential Increase in Property Values and Area Revitalization
- Large-scale industrial/tech development in a zoned area often raises nearby home values through economic growth, better services, and perception of the region as a growing hub.
- Belvidere already has an industrial character so the data center fits without clashing with residential zones. A mile away positions you close enough to benefit from the growth "halo" (new investment, jobs, spending) but buffered from direct operations.
Long-Term Community Stability and Quality-of-Life Gains
- Ongoing tax revenue stream for decades funds sustained improvements in parks, public safety, and education that you and your family actually use.
- Positions Belvidere as more attractive for future investment/tech jobs, which can mean better amenities, stronger local economy, and more opportunities without relying solely on traditional manufacturing.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:49 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

I have read that China and some of their useful idiots like Neville Singham are funding anti-AI and data center opposition efforts to hamstring American technology in that arms race. I believe that is probably happening, like what they did with man-made climate panic because China had the lead in all of that "Green" stupidity.
Every good American wants to see us build and buy American. Stop sending our dollars overseas. But not with technology? I don't get it.
At least we can again build a nuclear power plant. Mine more coal- especially here in Illinois. We can pump more oil, or pipe more from Alberta.
But once we give our technology edge to China we can't go dig that out of the ground somewhere in this country.

From: Mike Vail <
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:42:22 PM

To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I agree with you.
Most of the misinformation is being generated through AI go figure.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:40 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:
You're welcome. I can't believe a couple short years ago governments were pouring out tax dollars to bring one in- and now when there is public concern showing up before an election politicians, even in Texas, suddenly act like they came here from Wuhan and we need 6 weeks to slow the spread. Gives you whiplash.

From: Mike Vail <[redacted].com>
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:08:05 PM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Thanks for the info and the link. I appreciate you doing the homework on this.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:06 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:
A year or so ago I didn't know there was such a thing. I had driven past a huge facility south of Dekalb that didn't look like what an Amazon or Nestles ought to. I found out it was one of the data centers. I understand in the early days there were tax incentives doled out to entice them- like Rockford wanted to do with TIF down by the airport. I have been doing all the homework I can to determine if it fits here, and definitely without any tax breaks at all. Chrysler generated the same opposition when they announced they were coming. There was no Facebook for the outrage porn and naysayers then. The payback came when the assessor worked up the tax bill for Chrysler and they contested their assessment. And after a few years, they won, with reimbursement due. Only the school district had properly escrowed the disputed funds. The city of Belvidere was nearly broken paying back its share. There were no raises for city employees available. Com Ed went through the exact same problem with Byron's generating plant.
I have a long memory. I plan to do the homework needed to make the best call and avoid the past mistakes if we do get an application to proceed. https://www.northernpublicradio.org/illinois/2025-12-09/dekalb-city-council-gives-green-light-to-data-center-project

---

From: Mike Vail <
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 7:29:32 AM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Looks like the city fathers have a mess on their hands. Belvidere Facebook pages are full of negativity about this. Is there a source where people can find the real pro's and con's on data centers?

Mike Drella

From: rpeterson@belvidereil.gov
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 6:51 PM
To: mvail1953@gmail.com
Subject: Re: Data center

That was excellent.

From: Mike Vail <r
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:52:08 PM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I agree with you.

What say you people

People really need to educate themselves on how this stuff works before they start talking about things they're afraid of, and have little to no knowledge of, like they're the experts.

That's why we keep losing things that only upset a handful of uneducated people.

The biggest one being the water conspiracy.

This is a false narrative that is entirely all too often spread, the cooling systems use closed loops that very rarely need replenished.

It is not like manufacturing facilities where they use water in the manufacturing process and then dump it into the river... Even when the Byron cooling towers dump water into the river it has to be cleaner than when they got it.

Not to mention you can't run dirty water through computer systems they will short, clog, and in general fail from the buildup of the impurities... You couldn't just run River water through a radiator guys especially not long term. It really doesn't take that much common sense to figure that out.

No, data centers do not produce runoff waste the same way that normal factories do. Also you live in the middle of a industrial city, factories are a normal thing.

Major Boost to Local Tax Revenue (Biggest Direct Win for Residents)
- The project is expected to generate a **record-level ~$60 million annually in property taxes— more than any single site has ever contributed.
- This money is earmarked for core services: **schools, parks, libraries, community college, police, fire, and general infrastructure**.
- Result for you: Potentially lower or stabilized property tax rates (less burden on homeowners), better-funded public services, and more money for local improvements without new taxes. Officials explicitly noted it could mean "less burden on property owners and more money for schools and parks."

Job Creation and Local Economic Stimulus
1,000+ temporary construction jobs over several years of building — good-paying work for local trades (electricians, laborers, technicians, etc.). Many residents or their family/friends could benefit directly or through subcontractors.
200+ permanent high-tech/operations jobs once running (technicians, security, facility managers, IT roles) — typically above-average wages.
- Broader ripple effect: Workers spend money locally (restaurants, retail, housing, services), creating indirect jobs and supporting small businesses in Belvidere and nearby areas. This is described as the largest private investment in the region's history and a step toward attracting more innovative, long-term businesses.
Infrastructure Upgrades That Benefit Nearby Homes
- A project of this scale requires reliable power, roads, utilities, and possibly broadband enhancements. The developer (an energy-focused company) and local partners will invest in or trigger these upgrades.
- For someone a mile away: You could see improved roads/access near the airport area, more stable power delivery (data centers often partner on grid reinforcements), and upgraded utilities that serve the whole surrounding neighborhood — without the full cost falling on taxpayers.
- The site already has some supporting infrastructure (previously eyed for a waste-to-energy project tied to nearby landfills), so upgrades build on existing assets.
Potential Increase in Property Values and Area Revitalization
- Large-scale industrial/tech development in a zoned area often raises nearby home values through economic growth, better services, and perception of the region as a growing hub.
- Belvidere already has an industrial character so the data center fits without clashing with residential zones. A mile away positions you close enough to benefit from the growth "halo" (new investment, jobs, spending) but buffered from direct operations.
Long-Term Community Stability and Quality-of-Life Gains
- Ongoing tax revenue stream for decades funds sustained improvements in parks, public safety, and education that you and your family actually use.
- Positions Belvidere as more attractive for future investment/tech jobs, which can mean better amenities, stronger local economy, and more opportunities without relying solely on traditional manufacturing.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:49 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

I have read that China and some of their useful idiots like Neville Singham are funding anti-AI and data center opposition efforts to hamstring American technology in that arms race. I believe that is probably happening, like what they did with man-made climate panic because China had the lead in all of that "Green" stupidity. Every good American wants to see us build and buy American. Stop sending our dollars overseas. But not with technology? I don't get it.
At least we can again build a nuclear power plant. Mine more coal- especially here in Illinois. We can pump more oil, or pipe more from Alberta.
But once we give our technology edge to China we can't go dig that out of the ground somewhere in this country.

From: Mike Vail
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:42:22 PM

To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I agree with you.
Most of the misinformation is being generated through AI go figure.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:40 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

You're welcome. I can't believe a couple short years ago governments were pouring out tax dollars to bring one in- and now when there is public concern showing up before an election politicians, even in Texas, suddenly act like they came here from Wuhan and we need 6 weeks to slow the spread. Gives you whiplash.

From: Mike Vail <
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:08:05 PM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Thanks for the info and the link. I appreciate you doing the homework on this.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:06 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

A year or so ago I didn't know there was such a thing. I had driven past a huge facility south of Dekalb that didn't look like what an Amazon or Nestles ought to. I found out it was one of the data centers. I understand in the early days there were tax incentives doled out to entice them- like Rockford wanted to do with TIF down by the airport. I have been doing all the homework I can to determine if it fits here, and definitely without any tax breaks at all. Chrysler generated the same opposition when they announced they were coming. There was no Facebook for the outrage porn and naysayers then. The payback came when the assessor worked up the tax bill for Chrysler and they contested their assessment. And after a few years, they won, with reimbursement due. Only the school district had properly escrowed the disputed funds. The city of Belvidere was nearly broken paying back its share. There were no raises for city employees available. Com Ed went through the exact same problem with Byron's generating plant.
I have a long memory. I plan to do the homework needed to make the best call and avoid the past mistakes if we do get an application to proceed. https://www.northernpublicradio.org/illinois/2025-12-09/dekalb-city-council-gives-green-light-to-data-center-project

---

From: Mike Vail <
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 7:29:32 AM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Looks like the city fathers have a mess on their hands. Belvidere Facebook pages are full of negativity about this. Is there a source where people can find the real pro's and con's on data centers?

Mike Drella

From: Mike Vail <[redacted]>
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:52 PM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I agree with you.

What say you people

People really need to educate themselves on how this stuff works before they start talking about things they're afraid of, and have little to no knowledge of, like they're the experts.

That's why we keep losing things that only upset a handful of uneducated people.

The biggest one being the water conspiracy.

This is a false narrative that is entirely all too often spread, the cooling systems use closed loops that very rarely need replenished.

It is not like manufacturing facilities where they use water in the manufacturing process and then dump it into the river... Even when the Byron cooling towers dump water into the river it has to be cleaner than when they got it.

Not to mention you can't run dirty water through computer systems they will short, clog, and in general fail from the buildup of the impurities... You couldn't just run River water through a radiator guys especially not long term. It really doesn't take that much common sense to figure that out.

No, data centers do not produce runoff waste the same way that normal factories do. Also you live in the middle of a industrial city, factories are a normal thing.

Major Boost to Local Tax Revenue (Biggest Direct Win for Residents)
- The project is expected to generate a **record-level ~$60 million annually in property taxes— more than any single site has ever contributed.
- This money is earmarked for core services: **schools, parks, libraries, community college, police, fire, and general infrastructure**.
- Result for you: Potentially lower or stabilized property tax rates (less burden on homeowners), better-funded public services, and more money for local improvements without new taxes. Officials explicitly noted it could mean "less burden on property owners and more money for schools and parks."

Job Creation and Local Economic Stimulus
1,000+ temporary construction jobs over several years of building — good-paying work for local trades (electricians, laborers, technicians, etc.). Many residents or their family/friends could benefit directly or through subcontractors.
200+ permanent high-tech/operations jobs once running (technicians, security, facility managers, IT roles) — typically above-average wages.
- Broader ripple effect: Workers spend money locally (restaurants, retail, housing, services), creating indirect jobs and supporting small businesses in Belvidere and nearby areas. This is described as the largest private investment in the

region's history and a step toward attracting more innovative, long-term businesses.
Infrastructure Upgrades That Benefit Nearby Homes
- A project of this scale requires reliable power, roads, utilities, and possibly broadband enhancements. The developer (an energy-focused company) and local partners will invest in or trigger these upgrades.
- For someone a mile away: You could see improved roads/access near the airport area, more stable power delivery (data centers often partner on grid reinforcements), and upgraded utilities that serve the whole surrounding neighborhood — without the full cost falling on taxpayers.
- The site already has some supporting infrastructure (previously eyed for a waste-to-energy project tied to nearby landfills), so upgrades build on existing assets.
Potential Increase in Property Values and Area Revitalization
- Large-scale industrial/tech development in a zoned area often raises nearby home values through economic growth, better services, and perception of the region as a growing hub.
- Belvidere already has an industrial character so the data center fits without clashing with residential zones. A mile away positions you close enough to benefit from the growth "halo" (new investment, jobs, spending) but buffered from direct operations.
Long-Term Community Stability and Quality-of-Life Gains
- Ongoing tax revenue stream for decades funds sustained improvements in parks, public safety, and education that you and your family actually use.
- Positions Belvidere as more attractive for future investment/tech jobs, which can mean better amenities, stronger local economy, and more opportunities without relying solely on traditional manufacturing.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:49 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

I have read that China and some of their useful idiots like Neville Singham are funding anti-AI and data center opposition efforts to hamstring American technology in that arms race. I believe that is probably happening, like what they did with man-made climate panic because China had the lead in all of that "Green" stupidity.

Every good American wants to see us build and buy American. Stop sending our dollars overseas. But not with technology? I don't get it.

At least we can again build a nuclear power plant. Mine more coal- especially here in Illinois. We can pump more oil, or pipe more from Alberta.

But once we give our technology edge to China we can't go dig that out of the ground somewhere in this country.

From: Mike Vail <
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:42:22 PM

To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I agree with you.

Most of the misinformation is being generated through AI go figure.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:40 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

You're welcome. I can't believe a couple short years ago governments were pouring out tax dollars to bring one in- and now when there is public concern showing up before an election politicians, even in Texas, suddenly act like they came here from Wuhan and we need 6 weeks to slow the spread. Gives you whiplash.

From: Mike Vail <
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:08:05 PM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Thanks for the info and the link. I appreciate you doing the homework on this.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:06 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

A year or so ago I didn't know there was such a thing. I had driven past a huge facility south of Dekalb that didn't look like what an Amazon or Nestles ought to. I found out it was one of the data centers. I understand in the early days there were tax incentives doled out to entice them- like Rockford wanted to do with TIF down by the airport. I have been doing all the homework I can to determine if it fits here, and definitely without any tax breaks at all. Chrysler generated the same opposition when they announced they were coming. There was no Facebook for the outrage porn and naysayers then. The payback came when the assessor worked up the tax bill for Chrysler and they contested their assessment. And after a few years, they won, with reimbursement due. Only the school district had properly escrowed the disputed funds. The city of Belvidere was nearly broken paying back its share. There were no raises for city employees available. Com Ed went through the exact same problem with Byron's generating plant.

I have a long memory. I plan to do the homework needed to make the best call and avoid the past mistakes if we do get an application to proceed. https://www.northernpublicradio.org/illinois/2025-12-09/dekalb-city-council-gives-green-light-to-data-center-project

---

From: Mike Vail <n >
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 7:29:32 AM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Looks like the city fathers have a mess on their hands. Belvidere Facebook pages are full of negativity about this. Is there a source where people can find the real pro's and con's on data centers?

Mike Drella

From: rpeterson@belvidereil.gov
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:50 PM
To:
Subject: Re: Data center

I have read that China and some of their useful idiots like Neville Singham are funding anti-AI and data center opposition efforts to hamstring American technology in that arms race. I believe that is probably happening, like what they did with man-made climate panic because China had the lead in all of that "Green" stupidity. Every good American wants to see us build and buy American. Stop sending our dollars overseas. But not with technology? I don't get it.
At least we can again build a nuclear power plant. Mine more coal- especially here in Illinois. We can pump more oil, or pipe more from Alberta.
But once we give our technology edge to China we can't go dig that out of the ground somewhere in this country.

From: Mike Vail <
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:42:22 PM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

> This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I agree with you.
Most of the misinformation is being generated through AI go figure.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:40 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

> You're welcome. I can't believe a couple short years ago governments were pouring out tax dollars to bring one in- and now when there is public concern showing up before an election politicians, even in Texas, suddenly act like they came here from Wuhan and we need 6 weeks to slow the spread. Gives you whiplash.

From: Mike Vail <
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:08:05 PM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

> This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Thanks for the info and the link. I appreciate you doing the homework on this.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:06 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

A year or so ago I didn't know there was such a thing. I had driven past a huge facility south of Dekalb that didn't look like what an Amazon or Nestles ought to. I found out it was one of the data centers. I understand in the early days there were tax incentives doled out to entice them- like Rockford wanted to do with TIF down by the airport. I have been doing all the homework I can to determine if it fits here, and definitely without any tax breaks at all. Chrysler generated the same opposition when they announced they were coming. There was no Facebook for the outrage porn and naysayers then. The payback came when the assessor worked up the tax bill for Chrysler and they contested their assessment. And after a few years, they won, with reimbursement due. Only the school district had properly escrowed the disputed funds. The city of Belvidere was nearly broken paying back its share. There were no raises for city employees available. Com Ed went through the exact same problem with Byron's generating plant.
I have a long memory. I plan to do the homework needed to make the best call and avoid the past mistakes if we do get an application to proceed. https://www.northernpublicradio.org/illinois/2025-12-09/dekalb-city-council-gives-green-light-to-data-center-project

---

From: Mike Vail <r
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 7:29:32 AM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Looks like the city fathers have a mess on their hands. Belvidere Facebook pages are full of negativity about this. Is there a source where people can find the real pro's and con's on data centers?

Mike Drella

From: Mike Vail [redacted]>
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 4:42 PM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Re: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I agree with you.
Most of the misinformation is being generated through AI go figure.

On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:40 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:

> You're welcome. I can't believe a couple short years ago governments were pouring out tax dollars to bring one in- and now when there is public concern showing up before an election politicians, even in Texas, suddenly act like they came here from Wuhan and we need 6 weeks to slow the spread. Gives you whiplash.
>
> ---
>
> **From:** Mike Vail [redacted]
> **Sent:** Friday, September 4, 2026 4:08:05 PM
> **To:** Rory Peterson
> **Subject:** Re: Data center
>
> This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.
>
> Thanks for the info and the link. I appreciate you doing the homework on this.
>
> On Fri, Sep 4, 2026 at 4:06 PM Rory Peterson <rpeterson@belvidereil.gov> wrote:
>
> > A year or so ago I didn't know there was such a thing. I had driven past a huge facility south of Dekalb that didn't look like what an Amazon or Nestles ought to. I found out it was one of the data centers. I understand in the early days there were tax incentives doled out to entice them- like Rockford wanted to do with TIF down by the airport. I have been doing all the homework I can to determine if it fits here, and definitely without any tax breaks at all. Chrysler generated the same opposition when they announced they were coming. There was no Facebook for the outrage porn and naysayers then. The payback came when the assessor worked up the tax bill for Chrysler and they contested their assessment. And after a few years, they won, with reimbursement due. Only the school district had properly escrowed the disputed funds. The city of Belvidere was nearly broken paying back its share. There were no raises for city employees available. Com Ed went through the exact same problem with Byron's generating plant.
> >
> > I have a long memory. I plan to do the homework needed to make the best call and avoid the past mistakes if we do get an application to proceed. https://www.northernpublicradio.org/illinois/2025-12-09/dekalb-city-council-gives-green-light-to-data-center-project

From: Mike Vail <[redacted]>
Sent: Friday, September 4, 2026 7:29:32 AM
To: Rory Peterson
Subject: Data center

This message originated from an **External Source**. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Looks like the city fathers have a mess on their hands. Belvidere Facebook pages are full of negativity about this. Is there a source where people can find the real pro's and con's on data centers?